

MAC County Courier - May 15, 2026

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The County Courier

May 15, 2026

Data Center Summit registration is open

The Missouri Association of Counties, along with the Missouri Municipal League and Missouri School Boards Association, is hosting a Data Center Summit on June 17 at Capital Bluffs Event Center in Jefferson City.

This event will be limited to 300 people.

[Register for the event](#)

SAVE THE DATE

**DATA CENTER
SUMMIT**

June 17, 2026

**Capital Bluffs Center
Jefferson City, Missouri**

*Attendees must be members of
MML, MAC or MSBA.

Presented by:

Missouri Local Leaders Partnership



This event will cover:

- Understanding Data Center Requirements
- Utilities and Energy
- Impacts on Local Government
- Legislation and Legal Considerations

Watch for registration details from your local government organization.
We look forward to seeing you!

Get involved with MAC by joining a steering committee

Help shape legislative policy and be informed on emerging issues by getting involved with one of MAC's six steering committees for the upcoming 2026-2027 term.



To be considered for a presidential appointment, MAC members will need to complete an application form and return it to the MAC office by **May 31, 2026**. Applications can be emailed to info@mocounties.com .

If you have already submitted an application, no need to resubmit. Presidential appointments to the steering committees will be announced before the end of June.

Steering committee members will be expected to meet on the morning of Tuesday, Aug. 11 for in-person meetings at Camden on the Lake in Lake Ozark. Breakfast and lunch will be served for committee and board members only. Breakfast will be served at 8 a.m. with the steering committee meetings following at 10 a.m. Lunch will follow the committee meetings.

Committee members wishing to stay Monday night for dinner and hospitality will need to make a hotel reservation by July 9. Committee members, who are not already a member of the Board of Directors, will be responsible for their own hotel accommodations. More information will follow on the committee meetings.

[The application can be found on the association's web page](#)

Missouri News

Lawsuit challenges Missouri ballot plan to phase out income tax, expand sales tax

A lawsuit filed Wednesday seeks to knock a proposed constitutional amendment off Missouri's 2026 ballot that would give lawmakers new power to expand sales taxes to eliminate the income tax, arguing legislators bundled too many subjects into one proposal and wrote misleading ballot language.

The lawsuit, filed in Cole County Circuit Court by attorney Chuck Hatfield on behalf of a Missouri resident, challenges a proposed ballot question that would ask voters to amend the Missouri Constitution to begin phasing out the state individual income tax.

[Read more](#)



Wide-reaching Missouri election bill includes changes to automatic campaign donations

Candidates in Missouri will no longer be able to collect automatic campaign donations without the explicit permission of the donor. [Read more](#)

Industry experts, consumer advocates inform Missouri lawmakers of risks, rewards in data centers

Every email, like and click is physically stored somewhere. It's not in a mythical cloud up in the sky. It's in a data center. [Read more](#)

Multiple 'hyperscale' data centers in the works around KC. What that means, see map

As data center projects sprout up across the Kansas City metropolitan area, so are residents' concerns over what that means for their health and natural resources. [Read more](#)

Central Missouri's Fitzgibbon Hospital files bankruptcy, highlighting growing strain on rural hospitals

After years of economic strain, central Missouri's Fitzgibbon Hospital filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy protection and plans to sell to a private buyer. [Read more](#)

AG Hanaway announces seizure of 35 illegal gaming machines

Attorney General Catherine Hanaway was joined Tuesday by Columbia Police Chief Jill Schlude during a news conference on illegal gaming machines. [Read more](#)

Exit interview: Peggy McGaugh reflects on a career of rural service

Rep. Peggy McGaugh sat down with the Missouri Times for a reflective exit interview as she prepares to conclude her service in the Missouri House after decades representing rural Missouri at both the county and state levels. [Read more](#)

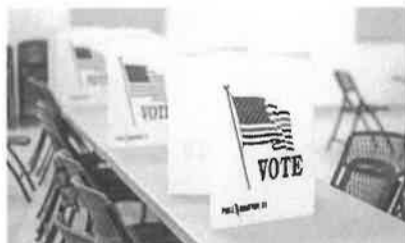
Healthcare bill expanding maternal care, contraception access heads to Missouri governor

The Missouri House gave final approval Thursday to a wide-ranging healthcare bill expanding women's and maternal health coverage, increasing access to telehealth and requiring licensed childcare facilities to maintain allergy treatment policies. [Read more](#)

Missouri senators vote to remove private school voucher program from treasurer's office

The Missouri Senate on Thursday voted to strip oversight of the state's private school voucher program from State Treasurer Vivek Malek, moving it to the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education. [Read more](#)

County News



Missouri clerks say they still can't update voter rolls for new congressional map

Missouri election officials can't revise voter rolls to reflect the state's gerrymandered congressional map because Secretary of State Denny Hoskins' office has not opened the statewide voter registration system to accept the changes, the president of Missouri's county clerks association said Thursday.

Miller County Clerk Clinton Jenkins, a Republican who serves as president of the Missouri Association of County Clerks and Election Authorities, said he and every other county clerk and election board is waiting on Hoskins on how to proceed amid uncertainty over a pending referendum petition. [Read more](#)

Developer yanks plan for huge Johnson County data center after resident backlash

After days of worrying that a massive data center might be her new next door neighbor, Gardner resident Kaela Eisenbarger celebrated the fact that the proposal will no longer be moving forward. [Read more](#)

'We do not want this': Missouri residents fight back against proposed AI data center in Nodaway County

Protesters gathered at the intersection of Belt and Frederick Avenue in early May, rallying against a proposed AI data center they say was pushed forward with little to no transparency from local elected officials. [Read more](#)

Camden County commissioners reject letter of support for Opportunity Zone designation

Camden County commissioners voted last week to deny signing a letter of support for a proposed Opportunity Zone designation tied to large-scale development efforts in Camden County. [Read more](#)

Boone County Sheriff asks commission to consider adding sales tax to ballot

The Boone County Commission is considering adding a sales tax increase to the future ballot, even as county residents might have to vote on tax measures from both the state and the City of Columbia. [Read more](#)

Long road ahead to cure Cole County's assessment ailments, assessor says at NT forum

It will take more than one reassessment cycle to fix Cole County's real estate assessment woes, Cole County Assessor Tim Therooff said last week. [Read more](#)

Ameren gets green light for Callaway County solar facility

Ameren Missouri will move forward with its 250 megawatt solar facility in Callaway County, the Missouri Public Service Commission decided Wednesday. [Read more](#)

Cape County receives MAC Trust safety award

Cape Girardeau County received special recognition at the state level during last week's commission meeting and was presented with the 2025 Risk Management Safety Achievement Award. [Read more](#)

Share your county's achievements and honors

The Missouri Association of Counties would like you to Show Me Your County.

Show Me Your County is a chance for our counties to highlight a program, initiative or praise a hard-working county employee who has gone above and beyond their duties or has received an award.

Counties can submit a 500-word or less description of the program, initiative or employee, along with pictures if applicable. Those submissions will then be featured on MAC's social media platforms and in the Missouri County Record magazine.

SHOW ME
YOUR COUNTY

[Submit your county today.](#)

May

May 15 - Session Ends

May 25 - State offices closed/Memorial Day

June

June 4 - MAC HR Training Day in Jefferson City

June 17 - Missouri Data Center Summit in Jefferson City

June 19 - State offices closed/Juneteenth

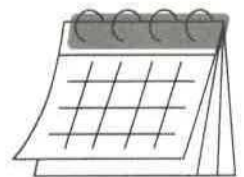
July

July 3 - State offices closed/Independence Day (observed)

July 14 - Last day for Governor to veto bills

July 17-20 - NACo Annual Conference

August



Aug. 4 - Official Election Day
Aug. 10-13 - Sheriffs' Summer Conference
Aug. 10-12 - MAC Summer Board Meeting
Aug. 28 - Bills become law
Aug. 31-Sept. 4 - Clerks' / Election Authorities' Annual Conference

Schedule of upcoming webinars for NACo members

NACo hosts several webinars for its members that cover a variety of different topics and programs for county government officials and their staff. Learn about the upcoming webinars and register to attend.



[View the webinars and register](#)

NACo Annual Conference in New Orleans, July 17-20

The NACo Annual Conference is the premier gathering of elected and appointed officials from the nation's 3,069 counties, parishes and boroughs. The conference will include dozens of committee and caucus meetings, educational workshops, general sessions and more. Sessions will offer learning and best practices on the full range of county responsibilities and domestic policy issues. NACo membership will also elect new leadership and set the organization's policy priorities during the Annual Business Meeting.

[Register today](#)

NACo member running for 2nd VP is offering Datacenter webinar

Mike Turner, Vice Chair of the Loudoun County, VA Board of Supervisors, who also serves as the Chair of both the National Association of Counties (NACo) and the Virginia Association of Counties (VACo) Environment and Energy Land Use Committees is offering a free 60-minute webinar titled, "County Lessons Learned from 'Data Center Alley,' Loudoun County, VA."

Webinars will be held every Monday at 3 p.m. CDT and Thursday at 2 p.m. CDT until June 30

[Register for the webinar](#)

Registration is now open for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium

Join county leaders from across the country in the Texas Panhandle for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium, presented by the Rural Action Caucus in partnership with the NACo Rural Energy Academy. Held Sept. 23-25, 2026, this event will offer county officials a unique opportunity to engage with the most pressing energy issues shaping county land use decisions today.

[Register now](#)



Governor Kehoe announces opportunity for more Missouri communities to earn Blue Shield designation

Governor Mike Kehoe announced Missouri counties, towns, and cities can now apply to be recognized as Blue Shield communities in 2026 for their dedication to effective law enforcement and community safety.

The Missouri Department of Public Safety administers the Blue Shield Program. Applications should be made by an official from the jurisdictions seeking the Blue Shield designation in coordination with the jurisdiction's chief law enforcement officer.

Deadline to submit is June 1, 2026. Applications are made online, and all supporting materials can be [uploaded here](#).

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